PROPOSAL & REQUIREMENTS

AI Reporting Assistant

On-demand inventory and financial reports, statistics and charts through plain-language requests

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Prepared for	[Client name]
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Confidential. Prepared for the named client's evaluation only.

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Revision history

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	4 October 2026	First draft for client review.
1.1	13 October 2026	Adds indicative costs (section 9), support and maintenance (section 10), data freshness and a reporting data store (sections 6–7), measurable finance gate targets (sections 8 and 13), and finance requirements for currencies, entities and fiscal calendars (FR-15 to FR-19). Expands risks and open questions.

1. Executive summary

We propose an AI Reporting Assistant: a secure web portal where authorized users ask for inventory and financial reports in plain language and get back the report, its statistics and its charts within seconds.

The solution builds on an existing large language model (LLM) rather than training a new one. The LLM interprets each request, queries the client's own data in read-only mode, and writes the narrative. Every figure comes directly from the client's systems, never from the model.

Delivery takes 17 to 23 weeks in four phases: discovery, an inventory pilot, financial reporting, then wider rollout. Each phase ends with a client sign-off gate with a measurable target. A 4-week hypercare period follows go-live, then an optional support plan.

17–23 weeks
to go-live, plus 4 weeks hypercare

USD 45k–60k
indicative one-off build, incl. 15% contingency

USD 550–2,400
indicative running cost per month (cloud-hosted)

> **Basis of this proposal**
> This proposal was prepared before the client's web portal, data sources and required financial reports were known. The report types, technology choices, timeline and costs are indicative. They will be finalized after discovery, once the open questions in section 12 are answered, and may change to fit the facts.

> **Key design principle**
> The LLM acts as a planner and writer, not a calculator. It turns each request into a database query; every number in a report comes back from the client's own data.

2. Background and problem statement

The client wants people using its systems to get inventory and financial reports on demand, tailored to what each person needs, complete with graphs and statistics.

Today, a custom report typically means a request to an analyst or IT team, a wait, and a fixed format. Users who need a different cut of the data, period or comparison must start over. An AI assistant removes that bottleneck while keeping the numbers accurate and access controlled.

3. Objectives and scope

The project lets authorized users self-serve accurate inventory and financial reports, cutting report turnaround from days to minutes.

Objectives

1. Answer report requests written in plain English.
2. Return a complete report: narrative summary, key statistics and charts.
3. Export reports to PDF, Word and Excel.
4. Guarantee every figure traces back to the source data.
5. Restrict each user to the data their role permits.

In scope (indicative report types, to be confirmed in discovery)

- Inventory reporting: stock levels, movements, ageing, slow-moving and fast-moving items, reorder alerts, warehouse comparisons
- Financial reporting: revenue, expenses, profit and loss summaries, budget versus actual, period comparisons, across currencies, entities and the client's fiscal calendar
- Web chat portal, report export, role-based access and audit logging
- Hypercare for 4 weeks after go-live, handover documentation and admin training

Out of scope (initial release)

- Writing to or changing source data (the system is read-only)
- Forecasting and predictive analytics (candidate for a later phase)
- Training a new language model from scratch
- Calculating consolidation eliminations that the ERP does not already hold (reports use the ERP's consolidated figures)
- Mobile apps (the portal will be mobile-friendly in the browser)

4. Users and roles

Five roles cover the expected users; the client will confirm the final list.

Role	Typical requests	Data access
Warehouse or store manager	Stock on hand, movements, reorder items for their site	Inventory, own site only
Operations or procurement lead	Cross-site comparisons, slow-moving stock, supplier trends	Inventory, all sites
Finance user	P&L, budget vs actual, expense breakdowns	Financial, by department or entity
Executive	Summaries across inventory and finance	All data, summary level
Administrator	Manages users, roles, report templates, audit logs	System settings, no report restriction

5. Functional requirements

Priorities follow the MoSCoW method: Must, Should, Could. FR-15 to FR-19 are new in v1.1 and cover financial data that spans currencies, entities and fiscal periods.

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	Users log in with company credentials (single sign-on preferred)	Must
FR-02	Users request reports in plain English through a chat interface	Must
FR-03	The system asks a clarifying question when a request is ambiguous (e.g. missing period or site)	Must
FR-04	Each report includes a narrative summary, key statistics and at least one relevant chart	Must
FR-05	Statistics include totals, averages, minimum and maximum, percentage change and period-over-period variance where relevant	Must
FR-06	Charts include bar, line, pie and table views, chosen to fit the data	Must
FR-07	Users can refine a report in follow-up messages ("now break it down by month")	Must
FR-08	Reports export to PDF, Word and Excel	Must
FR-09	Users see only data their role permits; restricted requests are politely declined	Must
FR-10	Each report shows its data source, filters, date range and a "data as of" timestamp	Must
FR-11	A library of standard report templates sits alongside free-form requests	Should
FR-12	Users can save and re-run favourite reports	Should
FR-13	Scheduled reports delivered by email	Could
FR-14	Interface supports a second language alongside English (to be confirmed)	Could
FR-15 NEW	**Fiscal calendar.** "This year", "Q2" and "last period" follow the client's fiscal year and period structure (e.g. July–June, 4-4-5), stored in the semantic layer; each report states the fiscal and calendar dates it covers	Must
FR-16 NEW	**Multi-currency.** Amounts are reported in the transaction currency or a chosen reporting currency; converted figures use the ERP's own exchange rates, and the report names the rate type (period-end or average) and rate date	Must, if more than one currency
FR-17 NEW	**Multi-entity.** Users can report per legal entity or consolidated; consolidated figures come from the ERP's consolidation, never summed by the assistant across entities	Must, if more than one entity
FR-18 NEW	**Period status.** Figures from a period that is still open are labelled provisional; reports default to the last closed period for P&L and budget vs actual	Must
FR-19 NEW	**Account mapping.** The chart of accounts is mapped to report lines (revenue, cost of sales, operating expenses) once in the semantic layer, approved by finance, with sign conventions fixed	Must

6. Non-functional requirements

Area	Requirement
Accuracy	All numbers come from database queries, never generated by the LLM; at least 95% of inventory pilot test questions and 98% of finance test questions answered correctly before go-live (section 8)
Transparency	Each report can show the query or logic used, so finance users can verify it
Security	Read-only database accounts; encryption in transit and at rest; role-based and row-level access control
Data residency	Hosting option (cloud API vs private, on-premise model) agreed with the client's IT and compliance teams
Data freshness NEW	Reports read from a reporting copy of the data, not the live ERP, unless discovery shows the ERP can take the load. Default targets: inventory refreshed at least hourly, finance refreshed daily. Every report shows its "data as of" time; final targets agreed in discovery
Source system load NEW	Queries never run against the live ERP without a time limit (30 seconds) and a row limit; heavy queries are blocked, not queued
Auditability	Log of every user, request, query run and report produced, retained per client policy
Performance	Typical report returned in under 30 seconds
Availability	99% uptime during business hours
Scalability	Supports the client's expected number of concurrent users (to be confirmed)
Usability	Usable without training by staff familiar with the business terms
Maintainability	New tables, metrics and report templates added through configuration, not code changes
Regression testing NEW	The agreed test question set is re-run after any change to the model, model version, semantic layer or data schema; a drop below the gate target blocks release

7. Proposed solution architecture

A request passes access control, the LLM plans a read-only query against a reporting copy of the data, results are analyzed and charted, and the finished report returns to the user.

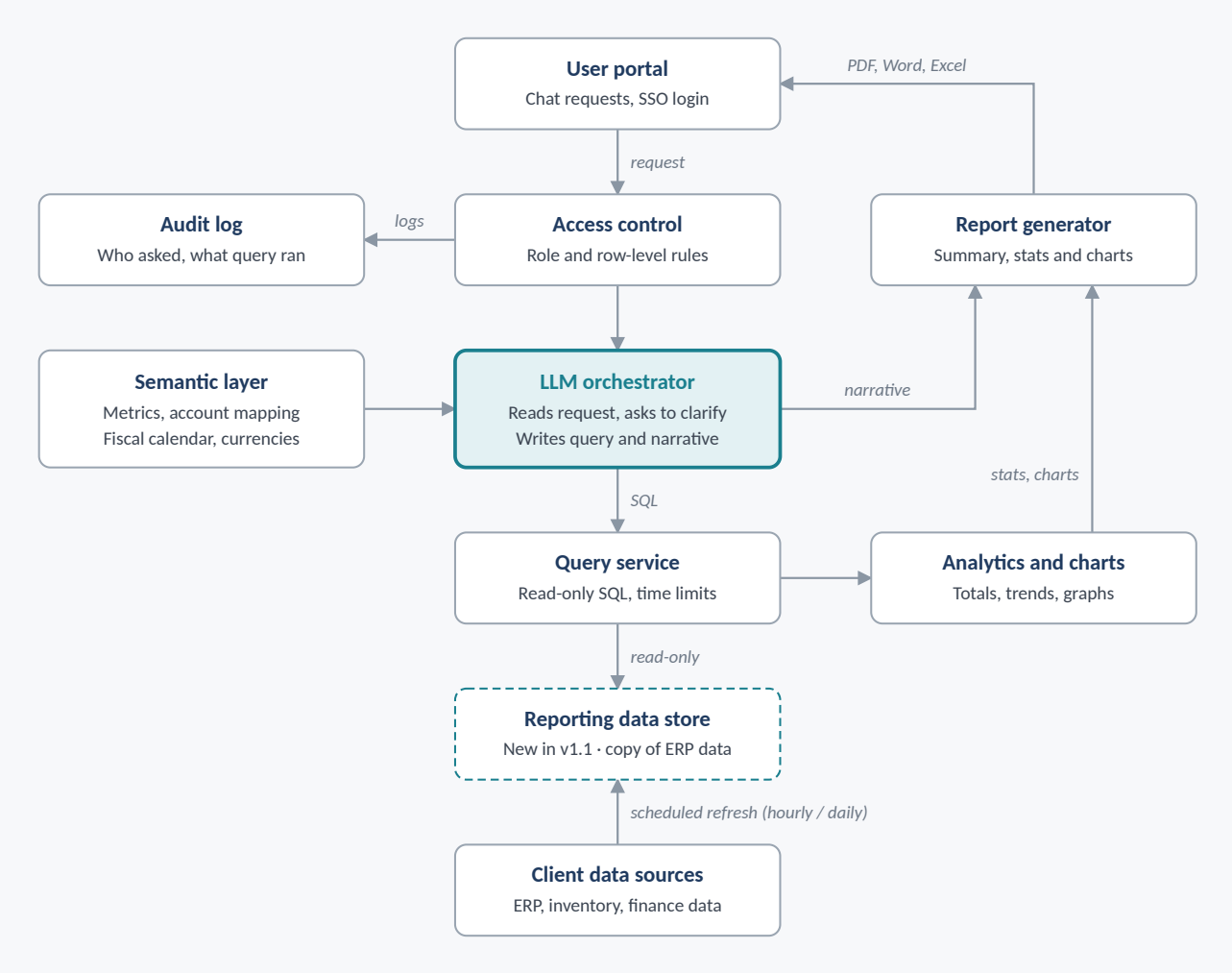


Figure 1. Solution architecture – ten components (reporting data store new in v1.1)

The reporting data store is new in v1.1. It is a copy of the ERP data refreshed on a schedule (by default hourly for inventory, daily for finance), so reporting never slows down the live ERP. If the client already has a data warehouse, it fills this role and nothing new is built. Every report shows the time of the last refresh.

Component	What it does	Technology options (indicative)
User portal	Chat interface, report viewer and download	React or Streamlit web app
Access control	Checks who the user is and what data they may see	Microsoft Entra ID or other SSO; database row-level security
LLM orchestrator	Interprets requests, asks clarifying questions, writes queries and narrative	Claude or GPT via API; Llama or Qwen self-hosted for private deployments

Component	What it does	Technology options (indicative)
Semantic layer	Business definitions of tables, columns and metrics, the fiscal calendar, account mapping and currency rules	Data dictionary file or semantic modelling tool (e.g. dbt)
Query service	Runs generated SQL with read-only credentials, time and row limits, and validates it first	Python service with SQL guardrails
Analytics and charts	Calculates statistics and draws graphs	Python: pandas, Plotly or Matplotlib
Report generator	Assembles summary, statistics and charts into branded reports	Templates exporting to PDF, Word and Excel
Audit log	Records each user, request, query and report	Database table or logging platform
Reporting data store NEW	Scheduled read-only copy of ERP data used for all reporting	Client's existing data warehouse, or PostgreSQL / SQL Server replica
Client data sources	Existing inventory and finance systems	Client's ERP, databases or data warehouse

Final technology choices depend on the client's existing web portal, data sources and hosting requirements, and will be confirmed after discovery.

8. Delivery approach and phases

We recommend four phases over roughly 17 to 23 weeks, starting with an inventory pilot because it carries lower risk than financial data, followed by 4 weeks of hypercare.

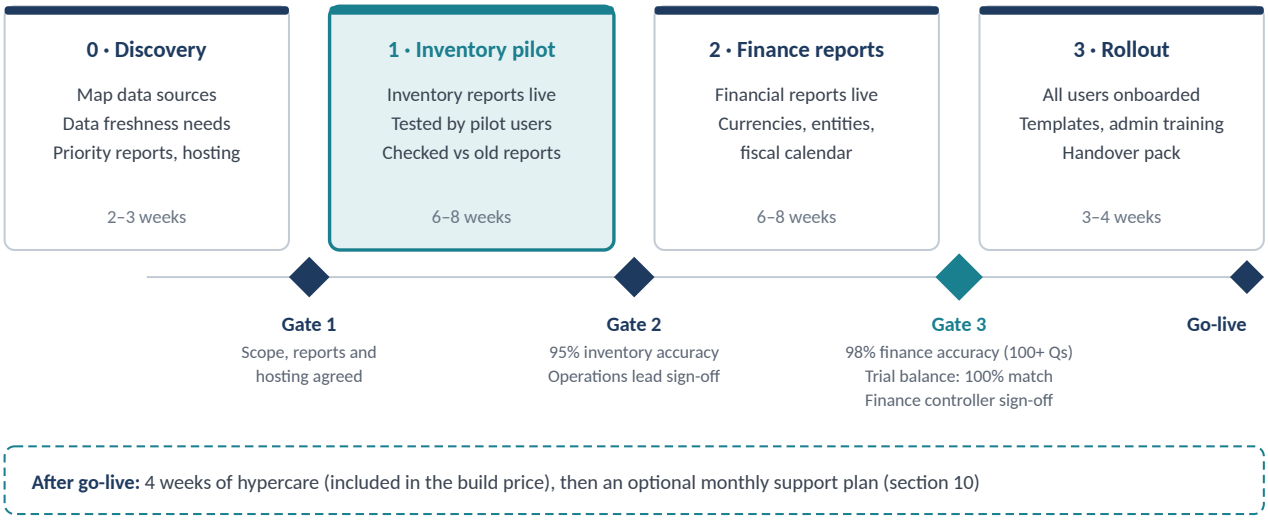


Figure 2. Delivery roadmap – four phases, three sign-off gates, then hypercare

Gate 3 is stricter than Gate 2 because wrong financial figures carry the highest risk. Finance supplies the test questions and expected answers from reports it already trusts. Durations are indicative and will be confirmed after discovery; the client approves each gate before the next phase starts.

9. Indicative costs

The one-off build is about 40 to 53 person-weeks including hypercare, or USD 45,000 to 60,000 with contingency. Running costs are about USD 550 to 2,400 a month for a cloud-hosted setup. All figures are indicative and will be re-priced after discovery.

One-off build

Phase	Duration	Avg. team (FTE)	Effort (person-weeks)	Cost (USD)
0 · Discovery	2–3 weeks	1.5	3–4.5	3,000–4,500
1 · Inventory pilot	6–8 weeks	2.5	15–20	15,000–20,000
2 · Finance reports	6–8 weeks	2.5	15–20	15,000–20,000
3 · Rollout	3–4 weeks	1.5	4.5–6	4,500–6,000
Hypercare	4 weeks after go-live	0.5	2	2,000
Subtotal			39.5–52.5	39,500–52,500
Contingency (15%)				5,900–7,900
Total build				**about 45,000–60,000**

The team is a solution lead, one to two developers, and a part-time data analyst for testing. Discovery can be priced and signed on its own, so the client commits to the full build only after Gate 1.

Monthly running costs (cloud-hosted, about 50 users and 10,000 requests a month)

Item	Approx. cost per month (USD)
LLM API usage (depends on model choice and caching of repeat reports)	300–1,500
Application hosting: portal, services, audit log, storage	150–400
Reporting data store, if the client does not already have one	100–500
Total	**about 550–2,400**

A private, self-hosted model replaces the LLM API line with a GPU server, typically USD 1,500–3,500 a month rented, or a one-off hardware purchase. Support after hypercare is priced separately in section 10.

Pricing assumptions

- Effort is priced at a blended rate of USD 1,000 per person-week (USD 25 an hour), to be confirmed in the final quotation.
- LLM and cloud prices are approximate as of October 2026 and change often; they will be re-quoted from current provider price lists at contracting.
- Client-side licences (ERP, SSO, Microsoft 365) and client staff time are not included.

10. Support and maintenance after go-live

The build price includes 4 weeks of hypercare after go-live; after that, the client chooses a monthly support plan or takes over support in-house using the handover pack.

Hypercare (included, 4 weeks)

- Daily monitoring of errors, response times and failed or declined requests
- Fixes to wrong or unclear answers, and semantic layer tuning from real user questions
- Weekly check-in with the client's admin and finance lead

Monthly support plans (optional, after hypercare)

Plan	Effort included	Indicative cost per month
Basic	2 days a month	USD 400
Standard	4 days a month, plus up to 2 new report templates	USD 800

Both plans cover:

- Incident response to the service levels below
- Updates when the LLM provider retires or changes a model version, with the full test question set re-run before release
- Semantic layer and query updates when the ERP or database schema changes
- Security patches and dependency updates
- A monthly usage and running-cost report

Service levels (business hours)

Priority	Example	Response	Target fix or workaround
P1	Portal down, or a user sees data outside their role	4 hours	1 business day
P2	A report returns wrong figures	1 business day	3 business days
P3	Enhancement or new report request	3 business days	Next scheduled release

Client responsibilities

- A named administrator who manages users, roles and templates
- Data owners give at least 2 weeks' notice of ERP or schema changes
- Finance approves any change to a metric definition or account mapping

Handover pack

Architecture and runbook documentation, the semantic layer and test question set (owned by the client), and two admin training sessions.

11. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
LLM misreads a request and queries the wrong data	Wrong report	Semantic layer defining every metric; clarifying questions; report shows filters and date range used
Incorrect financial figures reach decision-makers	**High**	Numbers only from queries; Gate 3 reconciliation against the trial balance; query visible to finance users
Users access data beyond their role	**High**	Role and row-level security enforced in the database layer, not just the prompt
Sensitive data sent to an external AI provider	Compliance breach	Private hosting option, or a provider agreement with zero data retention
Poor data quality in source systems	Misleading reports	Data quality review in discovery; known gaps flagged in reports
Currency, entity or fiscal period handled wrongly NEW	Wrong financial totals	FR-15 to FR-19: ERP exchange rates and consolidation only, fiscal calendar in the semantic layer, test questions for each case
Reporting queries slow down the live ERP NEW	Disruption to operations	Reporting data store; time and row limits on every query
Users act on stale data NEW	Decisions on out-of-date figures	"Data as of" time on every report; refresh failures alerted to the admin
LLM provider changes or retires a model version NEW	Accuracy drops without warning	Pinned model versions; full test set re-run before any switch (section 10)
Low user adoption	Low return on investment	Standard templates for common reports; short demos; feedback loop in the pilot
Running costs grow with usage	Budget overrun	Usage monitoring, caching of repeat reports, model choice by task; monthly cost report

12. Assumptions, dependencies and open questions

Assumptions and dependencies

- The client provides read-only access to its inventory and finance data sources.
- A client contact from IT, finance and operations is available for discovery and pilot testing.
- Reports cover structured data held in databases or an ERP, not scanned documents.
- Exchange rates and consolidated figures already exist in the ERP; the assistant reads them and does not calculate them.
- Finance provides at least 100 test questions with known correct answers, taken from existing reports, before Phase 2 testing starts.

Open questions for the client

#	Question	Client response
1	Which systems hold inventory and financial data (ERP name, databases, spreadsheets)?	
2	Can data be processed by a cloud AI service, or must everything stay on-premise?	
3	Who are the users: internal staff only, or also external users such as partners or customers?	
4	How many users, and how many concurrent users, are expected?	
5	Which 10 to 20 reports are requested most often today?	
6	Is there an existing login system (e.g. Microsoft Entra ID) to integrate with?	
7	Is branding required on exported reports?	
8	Is a second interface language required?	
9	What are the budget range and target go-live date?	
10	What is the existing web portal or website, and should the assistant be embedded in it or run as a separate portal?	
11	Which financial reports are required (e.g. P&L, balance sheet, cash flow, budget vs actual, receivables, payables), and at what level of detail?	
12	Which inventory reports are required, and for which sites or warehouses?	
13 NEW	How current must reports be: real time, hourly, or as of the previous day?	
14 NEW	Is there already a data warehouse or reporting copy of the ERP, or should one be set up?	

#	Question	Client response
15 NEW	How many currencies and legal entities are there, and does the ERP already produce consolidated figures?	
16 NEW	What is the fiscal year (start month) and period structure (calendar months, 4-4-5, 13 periods)?	
17 NEW	When is each month closed, and how are open versus closed periods marked in the ERP?	
18 NEW	After hypercare, will support be in-house or under a support plan, and who will be the system administrator?	

13. Success criteria, next steps and approval

Each phase must meet its own measures before the next one starts.

Measure	Inventory pilot (Gate 2)	Finance reports (Gate 3)
Correct answers on the agreed test question set	95% or higher	98% or higher, on at least 100 questions
Totals reconciled to the source for closed periods (P&L lines vs trial balance, stock value vs ledger)	Not measured	100% match
Currency, entity and fiscal-period test cases passed	Not measured	100%
Typical report turnaround	Under 30 seconds	Under 30 seconds
Pilot users who rate it useful	80% or higher	80% or higher
Unauthorized data access incidents	Zero	Zero
Signed off by	Operations lead	Finance controller or CFO

Next steps

1. Client reviews this proposal and answers the open questions.
2. Discovery workshop to map data sources, data freshness needs and priority reports.
3. Revise this proposal with the confirmed report catalogue, technology stack, hosting model, budget and timeline.
4. Start Phase 1 pilot on inventory reporting.

Approval

	Client	Provider
Name		Durrayshahwar Zehra
Signature		
Date		